2.19 Altered Bowel Elimination: Constipation and Diarrhea

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I have not opened my bowels for 4 days." **Objective** • Stool hard and dry • Abdomen distended	**ACTUAL** **Constipation** related to reduced activity and fluid intake as evidenced by no stool for 4 days and hard stool.	Passes soft stool within 48 hours.	• Encourage fluids and fibre. • Get her moving. • Give the laxative as prescribed. • Give her privacy and a regular time for the toilet.	Soft stool passed: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I have frequent watery stools." **Objective** • Liquid stools 6 times a day • Hyperactive bowel sounds	**ACTUAL** **Diarrhea** related to infection or medication as evidenced by frequent liquid stools.	Within 72 hours, fewer stools and the stool is formed.	• Record how often stools come and what they look like. • Send a stool sample if ordered. • Keep him hydrated. • Protect the skin around the anus.	Formed stools: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Diarrhea continuing	**RISK** **Risk for deficient fluid volume** as evidenced by risk factors: excessive fluid loss through stool.	Fluid balance maintained.	• Keep track of I&O and weight. • Encourage oral rehydration. • Give IV fluids as ordered.	I&O balanced: **goal met**.